



English Verb Tense Review

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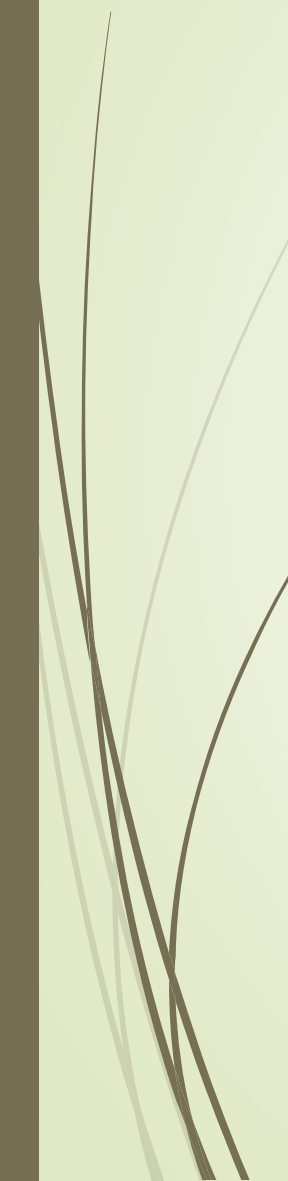
□ What are tenses in English?

□ The Tense of a Verb shows—

□ a) the *time* of an action or event and

□ b) suggests its *state* of action.

□ Past, present, and future are the three main types of tenses

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- ❑ 1. I *write* this letter to please you.
 - ❑ 2. I *wrote* the letter in his very presence.
 - ❑ 3. I *shall write* another letter tomorrow.
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- ❑ In sentence 1, the Verb write refers to the **present time**.
 - ❑ In sentence 2, the Verb wrote refers to **past time**.
 - ❑ In sentence 3, the Verb shall write refers to **future time**.

To express its *state*, it is further categorized into four parts within each type of time sense:

1. Present Tense	Present Simple	I love.
	Present Continuous	I am loving.
	Present Perfect	I have loved.
	Present Perfect Continuous	I have been loving.
2. Past Tense	Past Simple	I loved.
	Past Continuous	I was loving.
	Past Perfect	I had loved.
	Past Perfect Continuous	I had been loving.
3. Future Tense	Future Simple	I shall/will love.
	Future Continuous	I shall/will be loving.
	Future Perfect	I shall/will have loved.
	Future Perfect Continuous	I shall have been loving.

Here is a list of rules of these tenses:

	Simple Forms	Progressive Forms	Perfect Forms	Perfect Progressive Forms
Present	Ist form + s / es	am/is/are + Ist form + ing	have/has + IIIrd form	have/has been + Ist form + ing
Past	IIInd form	was/were + Ist form + ing	had + IIIrd form	had been + Ist form + ing
Future	will/shall + Ist form	will be + Ist form + ing	will have + IIIrd form	will have been + Ist form + ing



12 Tenses Formula

Tenses	Positive	Negative	Question
Present Simple	I prefer my coffee black.	I don't prefer my coffee black.	Do I prefer my coffee black?
Present Continuous	She is listening the music now.	She is not listening the music now.	Is she listening the music now?
Present Perfect	It has rained a lot lately.	It has not rained a lot lately.	Has it rained a lot lately?
Present Perfect Continuous	She has been singing a song.	She has not been singing a song.	Has she been singing a song?
Past Simple	We watched the news last night.	We did not watched the news last night.	Did we watched the news last night?
Past Continuous	I was learning German last year.	I was not learning German last year.	Was I learning German last year?
Past perfect	He had left when I went to the club.	He had not left when I went to the club.	Had he left when I went to the club?
Past Perfect Continuous	They had been being friend since childhood.	They had not been being friend since childhood.	Had they been being friend since childhood?
Future Simple	They will study math.	They will not study math.	Will they study math?
Future Continuous	They will be loving you.	They will not be loving you.	Will they be loving you?
Future Perfect	By next week, they will have earned lots of money.	By next week, they will not have earned lots of money.	Will they have earned lots of Money, by next week?
Future Perfect Continuous	I will have been shopping on Tuesday.	I will not have been shopping on Tuesday.	Will I have been shopping on Tuesday?



Simple Present Tense

Otherwise known as the
Timeless Present





Simple Present Tense is used:

- When you are referring to **habitual actions**--actions that you always or never do
- When you are referring to **unchanging truths**
- When you are **making general statements of fact**



Examples

- **(habit)** He always comes late to class.
- **(unchanging truth)** The sun rises in the east.
- **(general statement of fact)** They are friendly.

Indicators

Always

Whenever

Everyday

Usually

Often

Frequently

Sometimes

Rarely

Occasionally

never

Form

I study

You study

S/he/it studies

We study

They study

I wait

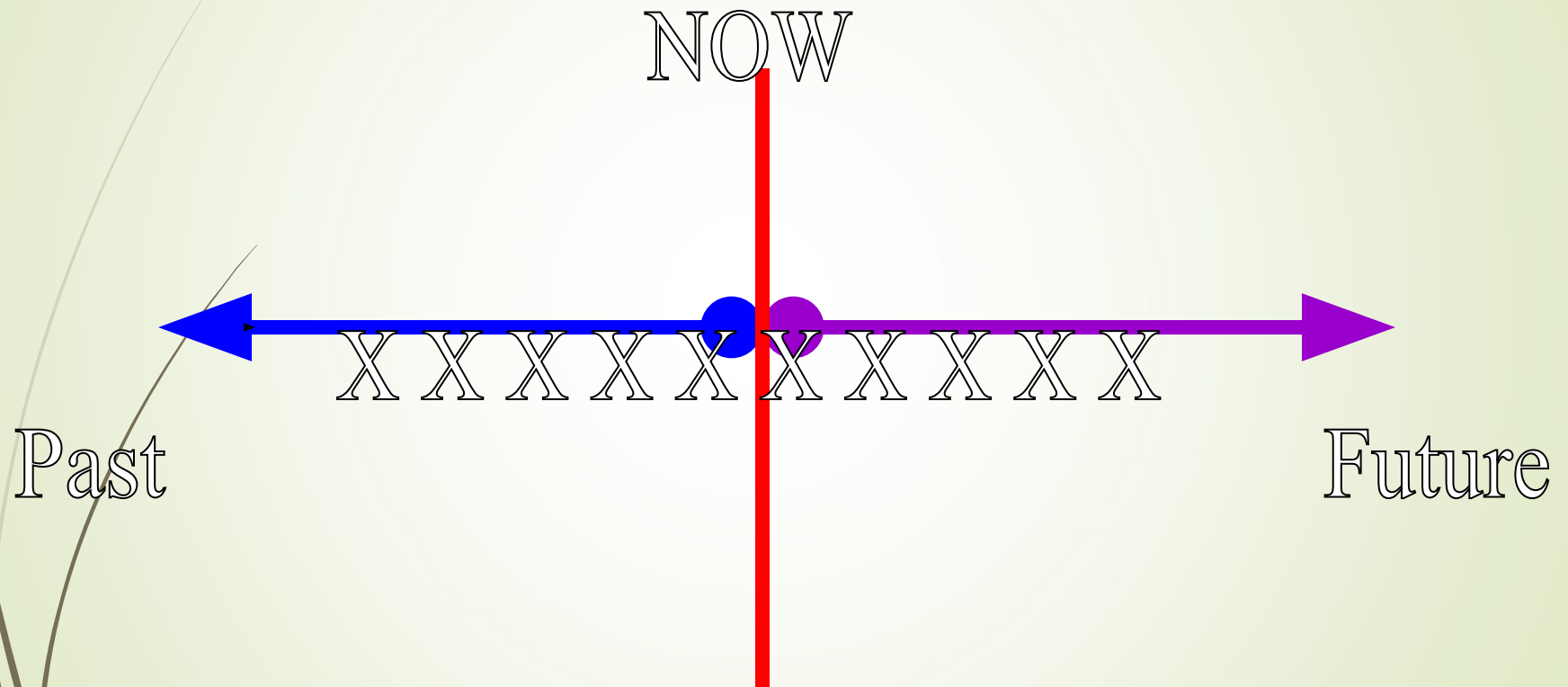
You wait

s/he/it waits

we wait

they wait

Diagram--time on a line



simple present tense

Simple Past Tense





The Simple Past Tense is Used:

- When an activity or situation *began* and *ended* at a particular time in the past--in other words, when an activity or situation is completed in the past
- To refer to past habits



Examples

- ❑ **(Completed action in the past)** He was late to class yesterday.
- ❑ **(Completed action in the past)** We arrived three weeks ago.
- ❑ **(Past habit)** She always wrote a letter to her mother on Sunday night.

Indicators

Last night, week, year, month, Saturday, semester, etc.

Yesterday

ago

Form

I studied

You studied

S/he/it studied

We studied

They studied

I waited

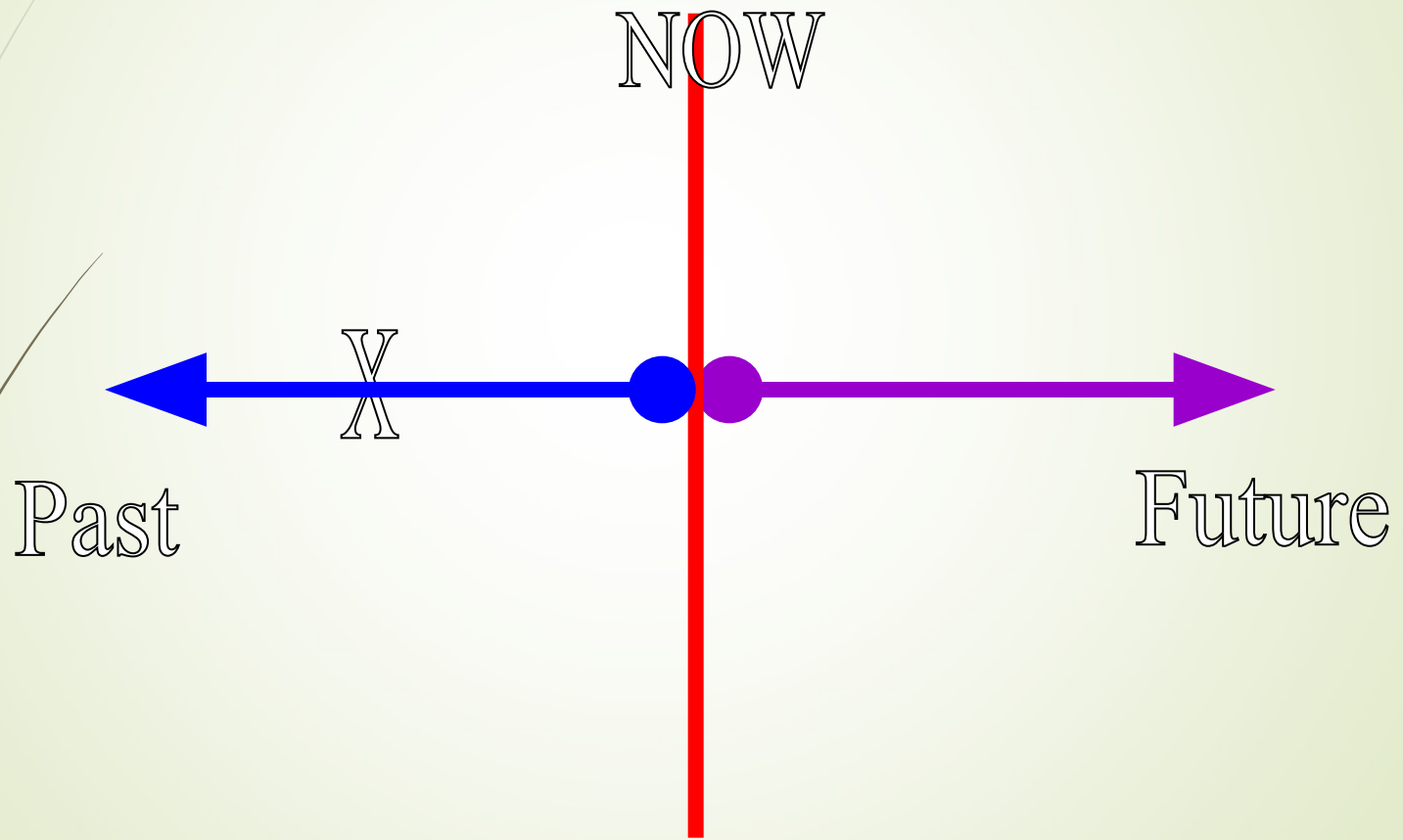
You waited

S/he/it waited

We waited

They waited

Diagram--time on a line



The Present Perfect

A tense very commonly used in English
to refer to the past!



The Present Perfect is Used:

- When an activity happened at an *unspecified* time in the past (before the present)
- When an activity has been *repeated* several times before now
- When an activity was very *recently* complete before now
- When an activity is *not completed* in the past

Examples

- **(unspecified time before now)** They have already seen that movie.
- **(repeated activity before now)** We have visited New York City many times.
- **(an action has recently been completed before now)** I have just eaten.
- **(action not completed in the past)** I have studied Spanish for many years.

Indicators

Before

Ever

Never

So far

Already

Yet

Just

Recently

For

since

Form 1

have or has + past participle

I have studied . . . I have seen . . .

You have studied . . . You have seen . . .

S/he/it has studied . . S/he/it has seen . . .

We have studied . . . We have seen . . .

They have studied . . . They have seen . . .

Form 2

I've walked . . .

I've grown . . .

You've walked . . .

You've grown . . .

S/he/it's walked . . .

S/he/it's grown . . .

We've walked . . .

We've grown . . .

They've walked . . .

They've grown . . .

Diagram 1--time on a line

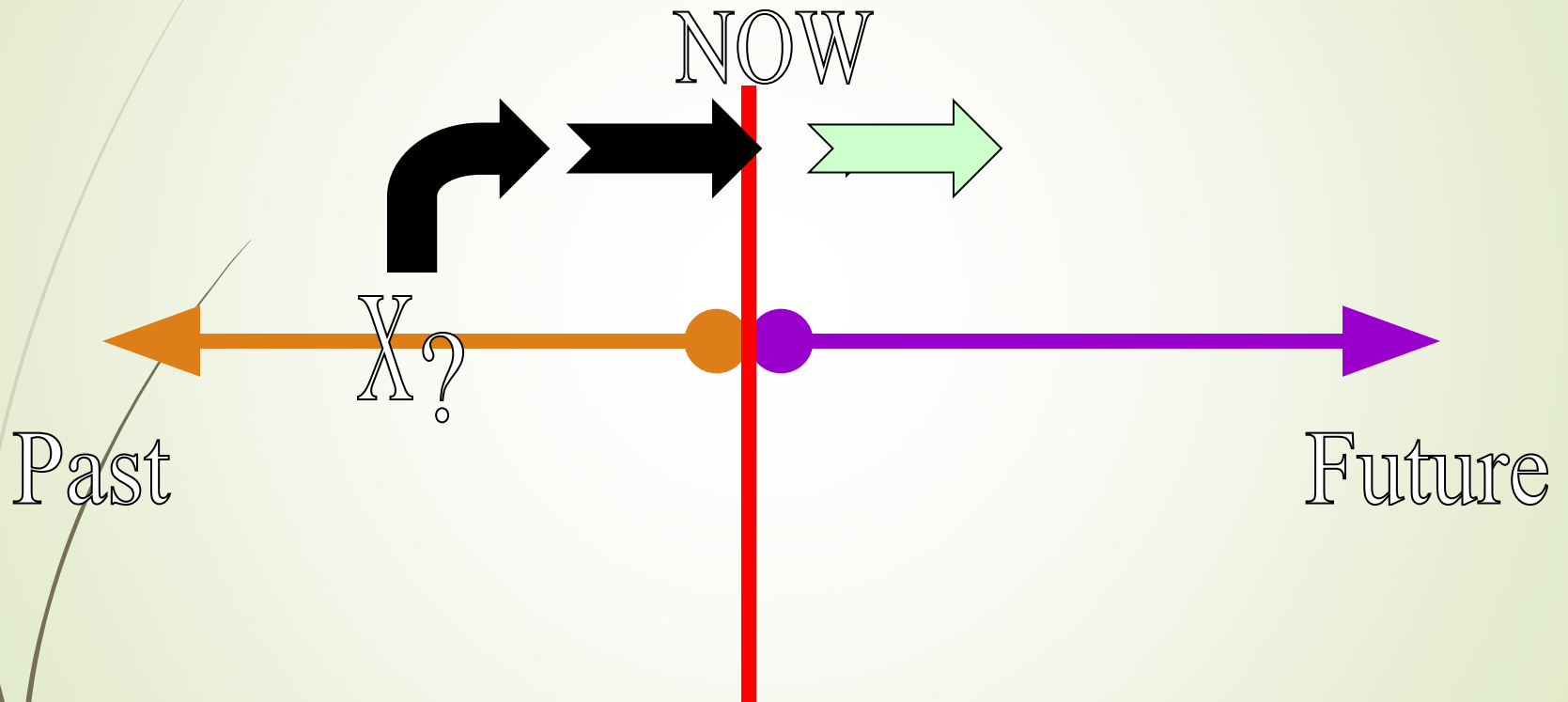
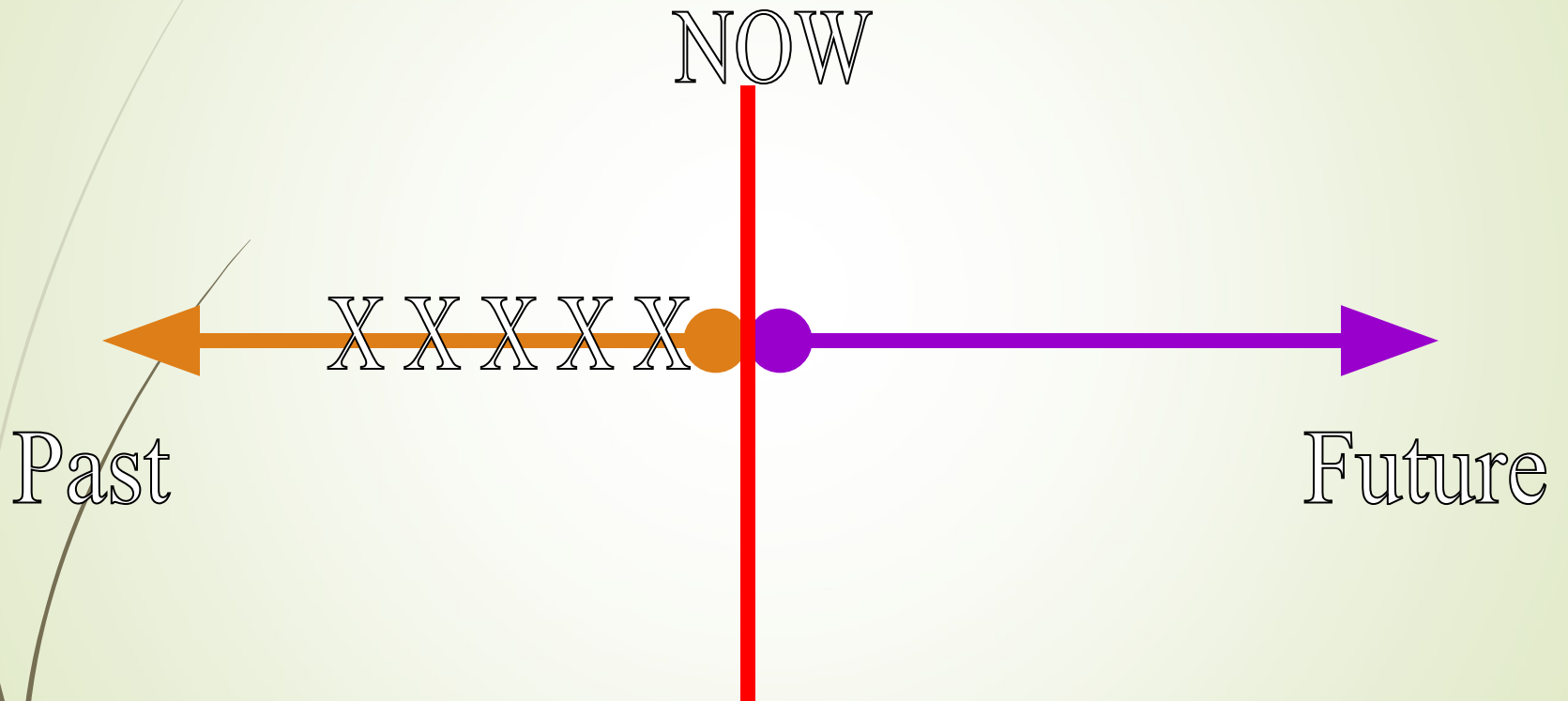


Diagram 2--time on a line



The Present Progressive Tense

Sometimes called the

Present Continuous Tense

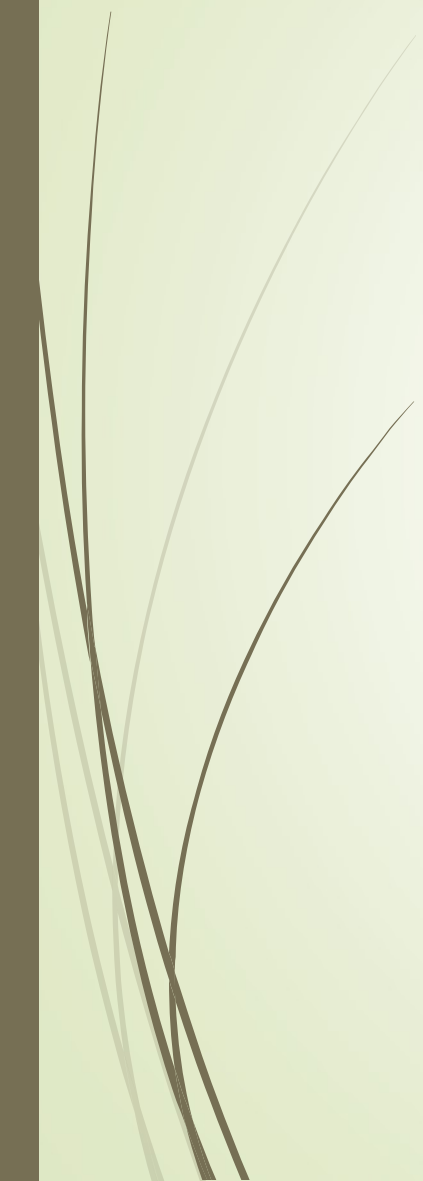


The Present Progressive Tense is Used:

- When an activity is in progress **now** at the moment of speaking
- When an activity began before **now** and continues into the future without stopping.
- When an activity is temporary.
- When an activity is developing and changing.



Examples



- I'm explaining something to the class right now.
- He's taking 16 credits this semester.
- She is understanding English more and more because she moved into the dorm.

Indicators

Right now, at this
moment

Still

This year, week,
month, etc.

As we speak

Form

I am studying

You are studying

S/he/it is studying

We are studying

They are studying

I'm studying

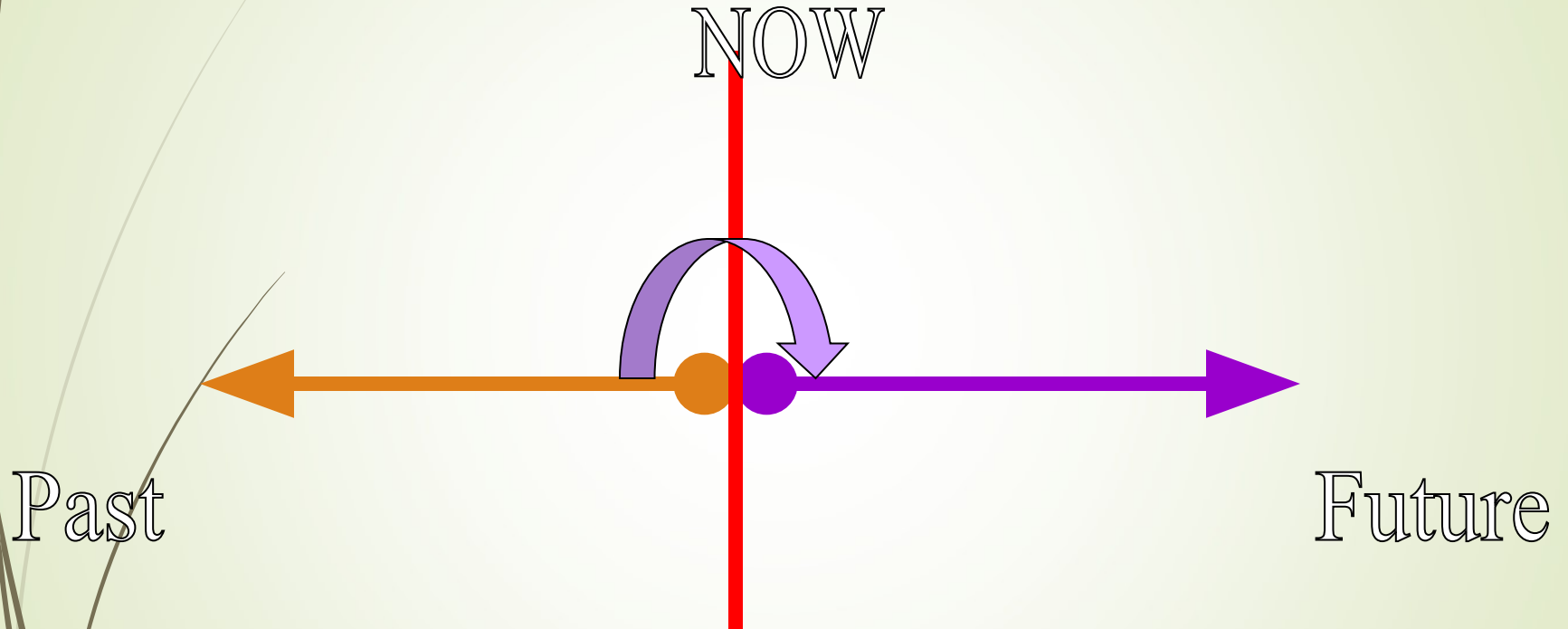
You're studying

S/he/it's studying

We're studying

They're studying

Diagram--time on a line



Future Tense



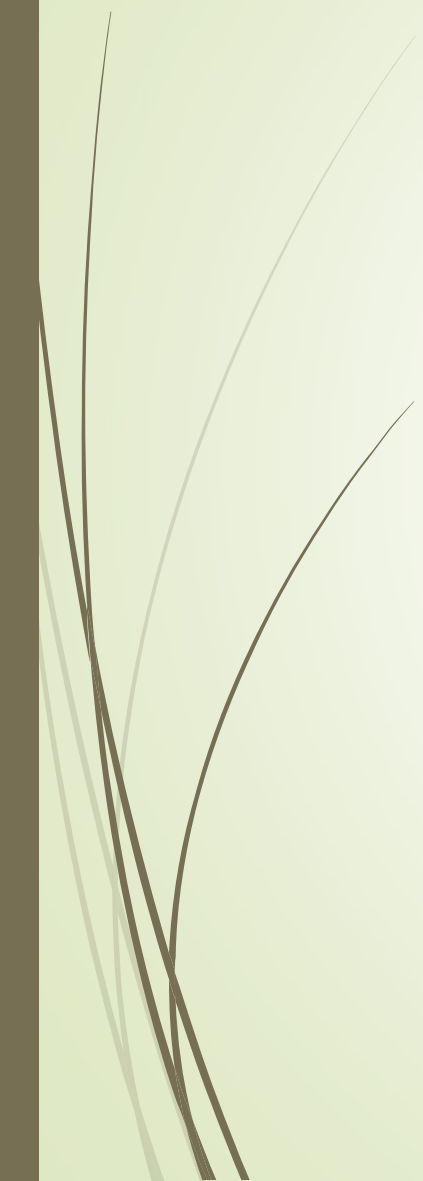


The Future Tense is Used:

- To indicate that an activity or event will take place at a time in the future



Examples



- When I'm retired, I'm going to travel.
- Next week, we will work on punctuation.
- He is going to get his car fixed tomorrow.
- Our plane departs at noon next Friday.

Indicators

Tomorrow

Next Saturday, week, month, year, etc.

Form 1

I will stay

You will stay

S/he/it will stay

We will stay

They will stay

I'll stay

You'll stay

S/he/it'll stay

We'll stay

They'll stay

Form 2

I am going to stay I'm going to stay

You are going to stay You're going to stay

S/he/it is going to stay S/he/it's going to stay

We are going to stay We're going to stay

**They are going to
stay They're going to stay**

Form 3

Sometimes the simple present tense or the present progressive tense are used to express a future meaning. Usually these tenses are used when scheduled events are being discussed.

I arrive

I am arriving

You arrive

You are arriving

S/he/it arrives

S/he/it is arriving

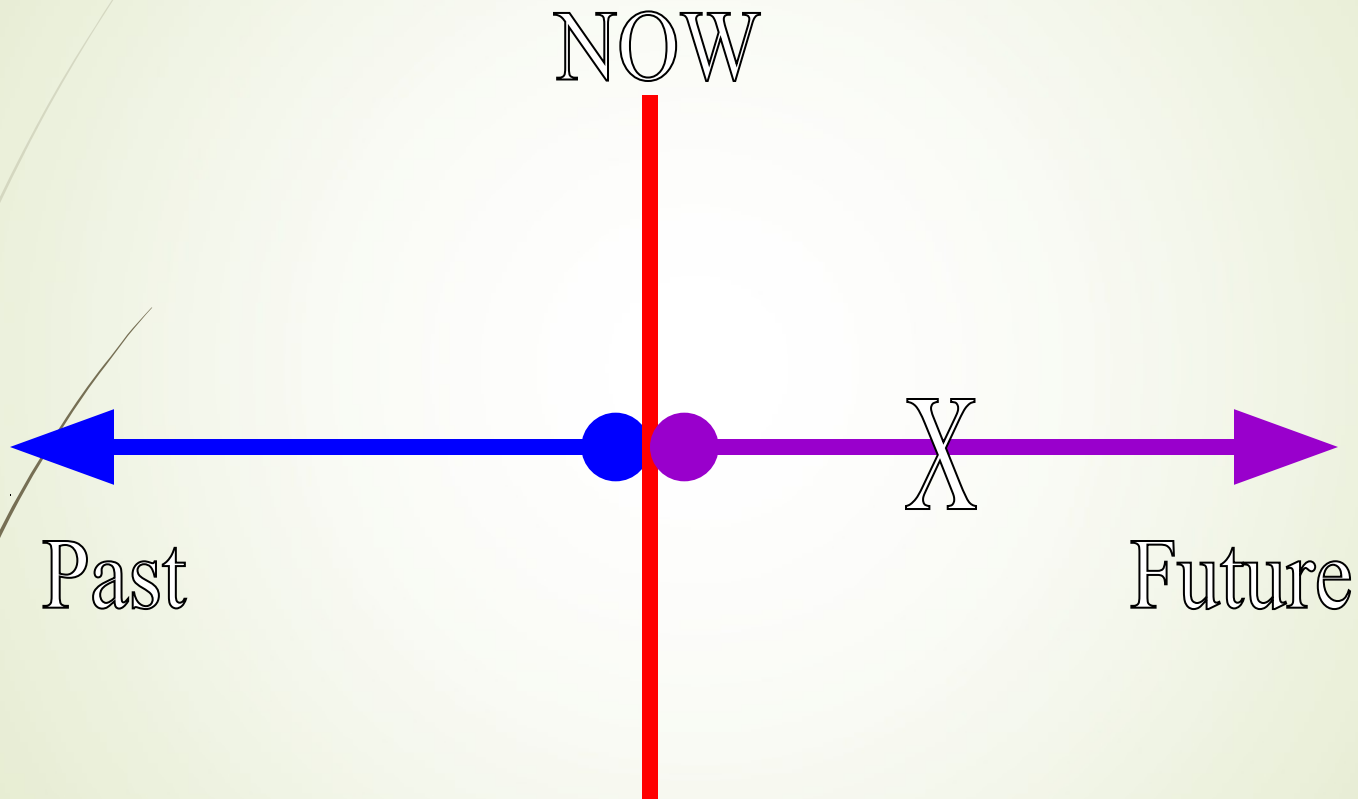
We arrive

We are arriving

They arrive

They are arriving

Diagram--Time on a Line



Future

Other English Verb Tenses



These tenses are combinations of the tenses we have just reviewed



Past Perfect

- This tense is not used a lot. It can often be used interchangeably with the simple past because these tenses do not differ much in meaning. The past perfect tense refers to activities that happened **before** a specific time in the past.
- Example, *He had visited her many times before she died.*
- Form: *had + past participle*



Past Progressive

- This tense is used to refer to activities *continuously* in progress around a time in the past.
- Example: *They were eating when the taxi arrived.*
- Form: *was* **or** *were* + **verbing**



Past Perfect Progressive

- This tense is used when an activity was *continuously* in progress **before** a specific time in the past.
- Example: *I had been thinking about her before she called.*
- Form: *had + been + verbing*



Present Perfect Progressive

- This tense is used to describe actions that have been *continuously* in progress **before** now. These actions are not completed.
- Example: *I have been waiting here for the last two hours.*
- Form: *have* **or** *has* + *been* + **verbing**



Future Perfect

- The future perfect expresses the idea that an activity will occur **before** some future time.
- Example: *She will have finished dinner before the game starts.*
- Form: *will + have + past participle*



Future Progressive Tense

- This tense is used to refer to activities that will be *continuously* in progress around some future time.
- Example: *We will be flying over New York at noon tomorrow.*
- Form: *will + be + verbing*

Future Perfect Progressive

- This tense is used to refer to activities that will be *continuously* in progress **before** a future time.
- Example: *He will have been working for 3 hours before you arrive.*
- Form: *will + have + been + verbing*

Overview of the English Verb Tense/Aspect System

	Simple	Perfect (HAVE + verb+en)	Progress-i ve (BE + verb+ing)	Perfect Progress- ive (HAVE + BEEN + verb+ing)
Present	*	*	*	
Past	*			
Future	*			

Exercise 1: Point out the Verbs in the following sentences and name their Tenses

1. The river flows under the bridge.

2. I shall answer the letter to-night.

3. I knew he was there, for I had seen him come.

4. It has been raining all night.

5. I hear he has passed all right.

6. I had finished when he came.

7. He takes but little pride in his work.

8. I have been living here for months.

9. Be good, sweet maid.

10. By this time tomorrow I shall have reached my home.

Exercise 2: Choose the correct or more suitable forms of the verbs to fill in the blanks

1. The plane _____ at 3.30. (arrives, will arrive)
2. I will phone you when he _____ back. (comes, will come)
3. When I get home, my dog _____ at the gate waiting for me. (sits, will be sitting)
4. I _____ the Rahmans this evening. (visit, am visiting)
5. Look at those black clouds. It _____ (will rain, is going to rain).
6. The train _____ before we reach the station. (arrives, will have arrived)
7. Perhaps we _____ Sylhet next month. (visit, will visit)
8. Unless we _____ now we can't be on time. (start, will start)
9. I _____ into town later on. Do you want a lift? (drive, will be driving)
10. The next term _____ on 16th November. (begins, is beginning)

The End

